

Week 3: Video Transcript

Hello, everyone. Welcome back to our week three module, 10 Pillars of Empowered Parenting. And today we're going to be discussing the map that we have created here at the Jai Institute for Parenting in service of parents who are committed and desire their path through parenting, to be a transformational process for themselves, for their relationship with their children, and for the planet in general, being able to really show up in your parenting, in your leadership, in your service, raising your children, raising yourself, raising your family on a day to day basis that is aligned with, and in integrity with, our core values. We're going to be discussing what Jai is offering as a map through this process. And we invite you to take what resonates and allow yourself to receive and be curious, move forward with an open mind. Some of these pillars may already match what you're doing and living on a day to day basis.

Some may ask for you to really dig deep and reflect what's coming up for you as you receive the information. Any resistances that you have or skepticism, and know that all of that is okay here. You get to have an honest experience and bring it forward to your coach. Bring it forward to the loved ones in your lives and use this as an opportunity to grow and transform. And it's not always comfortable. It's not always pleasant. It doesn't always feel like rainbows and sunshine. So however you navigate this space is totally fine. And let's go ahead and get started. So you'll have your workbook with you as well, that you can follow along, or you can look after this video, but I'm gonna walk us through the 10 Pillars of Empowered Parenting. And before I do, I will name the continuum of power parenting that we are going to be working with every day as parents, as caregivers, as humans relating to other people.

So while this is in reference to the parent child dyad, the relationship, this is also extremely parent centric. So we're looking at the ways that we embody and integrate and show up in these pillars within ourselves. And we're looking at the way that we integrate, show up and actualize these pillars in our relationship with our child. So a loving reminder that this process is parent centric, and this is about us gaining awareness, gaining information and clarity so we can show up more confidently and more compassionately in our day to day parenting journey.



So let's see, this is a bit of a spectrum, but way over here on this side, we have what's traditionally called as authoritarian parenting. We call it here, our language is power over, and this is the kind of parenting where a consciousness, a mindset, a belief system, connected to power over parenting is, I'm the adult. I know more, I have more power. I am the one who gets to say yes, who gets to say no. I am the one who knows what is right for my kid and what is not right for my kid. And this is typically attached with a belief system that can be conscious or very unconscious, meaning you don't even realize that it's happening for you, it's so normal, called adultism.

Adultism is an inherent power imbalance where an adult is up here on the hierarchy and a child is down here on the hierarchy. So we can discuss an element of equity. If you're aware of equity and how we strive as humans to bring equity into any given situation. It can look something like this. In adultism, the parent is up here and the child is down here and we expect and treat a child to be able to deliver behaviors, abilities, skills that an adult does. So we don't take into account their development. We don't take into account where they are at on any given day. We don't take into account whether or not we've actually been modeling and teaching these skills. Maybe we've been teaching skills and having high expectations for behaviors without any emotional support to facilitate the manifestation of those behaviors successfully, or we're lacking in our communication skills. We're just talking to our kids like they're adults. We're not really able to meet them where they are at. And again, this is a spectrum. For some parents there's resistance to even including any kind of equity, really meeting someone where they're at and giving them the support needs that they require in order to live up to what it is you're expecting of them. Some parents believe that that's not, that's not their job. They don't need to do that. That is they weren't raised that way. They weren't given empathy. They weren't given emotional support. They weren't given coaching. They were just told what to do and they did it. And so that mindset can continue. Well, I just did what I was told so my kids would just do what they were told too. Why do I need to give them emotional support? Why do I need to learn emotion coaching, positive discipline, like what? This is ridiculous and excessive.

And if this is you, I get it. It's completely counterintuitive to the way that most of us were raised and our parents and their parents. And so it's ingrained in our consciousness. It's just normal. And what we are looking at here is this deconditioning of, this is a fancy phrase, internalized adultism, where the adult doesn't want or see a need to understand what the child actually needs to thrive, actually needs to show up successfully in the expectations and the standards that a parent has, or the boundaries or the limits or the agreements in the home.



So you might find yourself in this power over parenting paradigm, when you are experiencing a lot of dysregulation inside of your system. You're high stress, you're overwhelmed, you're feeling desperate, panicked, confused, longing for ease, longing for simplicity, longing for harmony, longing for things to just work easily right away. Come on (laughs). So this is a very high stress response. So you might find yourself in power over strategies like control, threats, punishments, focusing on shaming behaviors to make them stop, because you're lacking the inner resources, the patience, the access to your breath, the ability to calm down your stress levels. You're lacking access to support systems.

Maybe you're a solo parent, or you don't have caregivers, or it's a pandemic and your child's been home from school for years and you're just running on empty. So I want us to really take into consideration and humanize those of us who find ourselves in the power over parenting paradigm. A lot of these parents don't like doing these things. They don't like using these tools and strategies. It doesn't feel good philosophically and theoretically, they don't agree with that space. However, they're lacking the support, the skills, the resources to support them, to shift those strategies into a more power with dynamic. And that can be really, really frustrating and isolating and full of grief for so many.

And so I invite you, if you, if you're resonating with what I'm saying to take a moment and put your hand on your heart and to allow the possibility that this isn't because there's something wrong with you, or because you're just not strong enough to be a power with parent. It's that this is a difficult practice. This can be a practice of relating with a child that requires a lot of inner resources, requires support from your external environment. And if you're not receiving that, I see you. And I want this to be a practice and a process where you feel safe enough to show up exactly as you are right now.

What's really beautiful about working with a parent coach is that you get to come and say, yeah, I mean, I threatened to take my kids' iPad away when he didn't turn it off when I told him to this morning, or I grounded my teen for the entire month, because they stayed up past the agreed time on their phone and I'm sick and tired of the conflict. You know, we get to just really own when we're showing up in power over parenting and receive the support we need to regain alignment and integrity with these 10 pillars I'm going to discuss with you. So again, the power over parenting paradigm is a consciousness, a mindset, and a belief system that is typically steeped in conscious or unconscious adultism. I am the power authority figure in this family, do what I say and do it now, and don't ask questions and I'm not interested in your opinion, and I don't wanna hear you cry. And if you're going to do that, leave my sight or else. It's very conditional, it's praise based or punishment based.



It is behavior based. And there's not typically a lot of warmth, emotional connection, emotional intelligence. And again, those things can be lacking in that relationship because there hasn't been enough support, resources, skill building, and connection.

So we have way over here on the other side of the spectrum is what is called power under or permissive parenting. Permissive parenting can be a way of relating with a child where the parent is very overwhelmed with the idea of their responsibility as a leader in the family. That experience can be extremely triggering for them, scary, overwhelming, heavy, burdensome, unable to cope with the responsibilities of positive discipline or communication. Being able to have clarity in your boundaries and emotional regulation, to be able to communicate these boundaries and then facilitate the child's experience in a connected, warm way. That is an amazingly sophisticated skill set that people who tend to find themselves in power under parenting, they find themselves there for a reason. It's not because they're lazy. It's not because they just don't care. It's typically not because they just don't wanna deal with it. It's usually a lot deeper.

Although superficially, it can look like a parent who's avoiding conflict, avoiding their voice, avoiding leadership, avoiding having any kind of power because in the past they've been punished or shut down or shamed because of their attempt to really step into their power, to step into their voice, to step into their boundaries, to be able to communicate and advocate for what they know and believe is right. And so if you find yourself more in the permissive or power under paradigm of relating with your kids of like, you know, it's time to turn the shows off honey, or I'm not feeling comfortable with you having the car keys past dark, but you're feeling really scared of any potential conflict that could come up and maybe conflict puts you into a freeze mode or a shutdown mode.

It makes sense to me why you take permissive parenting pathways in your relationship with your kid. So again, just like this power over that typically goes into more of a fight and a dominating response in order to blanket your insecurity or your vulnerability or all your past memories that are being triggered with your child, power under parenting is the very same thing just the opposite side of the spectrum. You make sense. There's nothing wrong with you. You're not a bad parent. We're not here to classify you and judge you because you typically go into a, I just don't wanna deal with it and just whatever, just do whatever you want. Ah, what do I know? I don't know anything. Just give up, shut down, retreat, usually a silent treatment. Just being frozen on the inside and feeling so powerless and helpless and overwhelmed completely that you throw your hands up in the air and you let the kids run the show.



I feel very strongly on both sides of these spectrums that you can receive this space as a, I make sense why I show up this way. Deep, deep down I make sense why I show up this way. So again, with power over parenting, there's usually a consciousness, a mindset and a belief system. Like the parent is supposed to have all of the power. The parent is supposed to be the one who has the final word. The child is lower in the hierarchy. There is this power imbalance that is disempowering for a child and hyper powerful for the parent. It just doesn't feel right. It's the similar thing over here with permissive parenting, it's just switched where the parent feels so powerless. So instead of feeling powerless and then dominating and putting their child into submission, I'm gonna show you how much stronger I am than you. I'm gonna show you how much more powerful I am than you by punishing, threatening, harming with my words or my actions.

Power under is I'm gonna show you how helpless I am by submitting and I'm unconsciously, this is very usually unconscious, you are gonna take the rightful place as the dominating role. So it's really interesting here is that a person who was raised in a power over paradigm can find themselves completely oscillating to the other side of that spectrum, where I don't want to repeat that dominating energy my parents had over me, and so I'm going to swing all the way over here into this excess amount of freedom, this excess amount of choice. And again, every family is going to be very, very different. Just because your family's boundaries are a lot more flexible around X, Y, Z and this family over here is a little bit more fixed and a little bit more specific and consistent in their boundaries with X, Y, Z, that doesn't automatically qualify them as permissive parenting.

So it's very nuanced. Disclaimer, very nuanced. There's that mindset, belief system, and conditioning here that who am I to have any kind of authority? Who am I to have any leadership? I'm stupid, I'm weak, I'm dumb, I don't know what I'm talking about. How could I possibly be a leader? I can't even take care of myself. How could I possibly take care of a child and lead them? So over here is this really inflated self-esteem and self-worth and belief in power. And over here is a very deflated self-esteem, self-worth and belief in power. So I want us to really deepen our understanding of power over authoritarian power under permissive parenting, because it's not just tools, strategies, and frameworks of actual parenting or disciplining. It's very deep. It's embodied, it's conditioned belief systems that have taken into the lineage and are spreading their tendrils out very wide.

So it's not really enough, a lot of the time, for us to just teach a power over parent a different skill set, or teach a power under parent a different skill set. It must be combined with the head work of the belief system, the mindset conditioning, the distorted perception of self and power and authority.



And also the heart, all of the memories, the emotions, the past experiences that they have with power over or under dynamics in their most intimate relationships. So power under, power over, and we have here in this middle way, what we call here power with parenting. And this is a pretty radical invitation for the human species as we evolve forward.

And I personally do not believe that this is a brand new way of parenting. I believe that this is our most intuitive, natural way of regarding a child and relating with young people. However, because of history of violence, colonization, industrialization, genocide, a lot of us have been ripped apart from our most natural, intuitive ways of showing up and treating young human beings. And for that there is so much grief and so much mourning and also so much hope and possibility for us to reconnect and remember this heart centric way of raising our young. And speaking this fills me with purpose and excitement because it's the perfect time for us to be making these changes back to our most natural state of parenting.

Power with parenting is the combination of a mindset that believes that children are sacred. That believes that we have as much to learn from our children, that they have to learn from us. That believes that the most powerful skills and tools that we could have as parents is the ability to witness, the ability to listen. The ability to really hold space for who our child is beneath our, above (laughs), above, beneath our expectations of who we think our child should be in order to be good or lovable or to belong. We have this radical humility that I get to step back and support my child to become who they are meant to be. I don't get to decide that. I have no authority in who my child is meant to be. However, I have an incredibly empowered, powerful role of being the facilitator, the coach, the guide on their life's journey.

So this is this incredibly honorable path of understanding that we are here to really keep our children safe and protected as they evolve and they fall and they learn and they grow. And it is a higher consciousness of relating with a small person, Really understanding that just because the size of their brain is smaller or their development is in a different position than ours right now, we are no more or no less powerful than them. We deserve no more and no less time, space, attention than them. We are equal with equity, meaning we're really able to meet our child where they are and to support them in the ways that they uniquely need. So our mindset is this: we are here on this journey together, and this child is not mine. This child came through me and I'm here to support them and model, and really understand what it is that they need from me, as this older person in their life. As their caregiver, as their mother figure, their paternal figure, their caregiver, whatever that is for you.

In addition, we have the skill sets that we're looking for within power with parenting, which is an emphasis on understanding child development, understanding our child's physiological unfolding, psychosocial, emotional unfolding, really understand where they are at in their human process and to be able to relate to them accordingly. We are here to really stand in clarity and confidence of our voice, of our ability to communicate, of our inner clarity of who we are and what we believe and our core values. We're here to model emotional intelligence. We know how we feel, we're able to name it. We're able to feel it. We're able to listen to those feelings and understand their communications and understand the needs and make clear requests and really live this vulnerable, transparent life. And this is a lifelong practice, and we're gonna show up like rock stars some days, and we're gonna show up like blah, some days.

So what's really beautiful about the power with parenting paradigm is that there's so much space for our humanness. There is so much space because we live with a core belief that our connection with our child is unbreakable, unshakable. There's nothing that could touch that bond. And we're embracing the power and the necessity of consistent check-ins, consistent feedback, consistent repair, being able to really authentically and transparently communicate. Here's where I'm at right now. Here's what my capacity is. Here's where my yes lies. Here's where my no lies. And I'm gonna show you what it means to be an honest human being with their limits and their capacity and their yes's and their no's.

So we're not living in this prison of power with parenting. I know so many students and clients of mine can feel so imprisoned by this offering and this invitation to show up in your parenting. It can feel like I call the power with police is over your shoulder at all times, watching you through their spy cam, watching your every move and evaluating you and checking off boxes and taking stickers off your chart when you accidentally threaten your child, rather than get low and slow and collaborative and play based. And I would like for all of us to take that power with spy cam and just toss it into the trash, burn it and whatever else we need to do to really get rid of spy cams, because that's not helpful is it. It's not helpful to feel like we're being judged and watched and evaluated and graded along this journey because it can be very messy. It can have some high highs and some low lows.

We really need to hold space for our humanity, that what a solo parent's journey with power with parenting may look like, compared to a parent of six kids, or a parent living with a chronic illness, or a family with two or three or four neurodiverse children with special needs, medical needs. We don't know. So there is no one size fits all in this by any means. And I want this to be abundantly clear that this is not a doctrine.



I am not here to convert you and indoctrinate you into this belief system. This is an invitation to really feel with your heart, what feels right. So often I'll ask a parent or a student or client, you know, tell me a little bit more about why you're here and why you're wanting to make this change. And so often their answer will be, the way that I'm parenting just doesn't feel right in my heart and in my soul. And we do not need a scientific study to back that up. We don't need scientific studies to understand that being in a dominating hyper domination or hyper submissive role with our kids is not the best for their development, or for our development or for our relationships development.

If we are living from here and from our guts and our soul and our spirit, we can feel it. So my invitation for you is to feel what feels right for you. And if you're not sure what feels right for you, that makes sense. That's a consequence of living out of authenticity and integrity and being dominated, or being in too early of a leadership role because your parent was more of this retreat and submit kind of person. So what I really want to normalize that going through this process is going to look radically different for every single person who arrives here. And without further ado, let's talk through these 10 Pillars of Empowered Parenting. You see in your workbook that we have broken this down into three categories, the Trinity, the head, the heart, and the hands.

Within the head aspect of power with parenting, our first pillar is informed and aware. So if you get nothing else from this program, you're going to receive a lot of information. And a lot of awareness. We are me, myself personally, I am obsessed with child development. I'm obsessed with learning the latest in brain science, the latest in relational brain science, how our relationship grows each other's brains, our nervous system, our sensory needs just how unique we all are.

Really being in that exciting process of learning who I am, every nook and cranny and learning my child, every nook and cranny, and then creating a parenting relationship with them that fits because I know myself and I'm learning. Every day I'm learning my child and I'm checking in with them and I'm asking them how it feels. And I'm asking them if the strategies that I'm using feel right and are really matching and trusting that even a two year old can say, yeah, mama feels good, or no, no mama, don't like that. We get to provide space for our children to share, how's this parenting relationship going for you? How's it feeling in your heart? Are there butterflies in your heart or are there rocks in your tummy? And it's beautiful to be in this collaboration.

Pillar two is intentional and reflective. I have a joke that's not really a joke, which is 99% of empowered, conscious, peaceful, gentle parenting, however you want to call it, happens in reflection. So as we're moving into this process of deconditioning our power over or under mindset, our power over or under toolboxes, we are going to make a lot of mistakes and regress into what feels most familiar and comfortable and accessible, especially in moments of stress. And then we're gonna sit down later that night, ideally with our partner or our journal or our parent coach and we're gonna talk about it.

We're gonna reflect on the moments in our day that, err shucks wa wa wa, and we're going to use it as an opportunity to learn. It's no longer this all or nothing, I made a mistake and I'm over. I must just quit and just move to a cave and never try again. It's like, okay let's reflect, let's unpack, let's make sense of it. Let's find the opportunity, let's recommit and let's go to bed and do it all over again. How exciting.

So the intention here is waking up in the morning and you know the moments in your day that are the most challenging for you. You know what really ruffles your feathers. And we get to set intentions with ourself and our kids, like let's make a wish for a day. If I could make a wish for our day, it would be, here let's hold up our dandelion and let's blow the seeds. My wish is floating into our day. My wish is peace, or you're going into teeth brushing, and you're blowing your dandelion seeds when you're making a wish and my wish is we're gonna have fun. We're gonna play through teeth brushing tonight. It's gonna be so silly and so fun. Even though a hundred percent, I do not feel like playing right now. I can access my magic wand and I can make my wish. And I can model intention setting with my child. It's really fun.

Pillar three under the head part of power with parenting is our committed devotion to imperfectly showing up. Doesn't that feel good? Instead of saying, I commit to showing up perfectly and committed every day. It's like, ah! I'm going to devote myself to my process. I'm going to devote myself to the beauty of imperfection. I'm going to devote myself to the beauty of authenticity. Like, all right kids, mommy's battery is about 10%. I think it's gonna be shutting off in about 0.7 seconds so what could we do to bring ease in this moment? Or mommy's fully charged, let's do this. Let's rock.

You know, we get to really tell our kids where we're at. We get to be honest. It's awesome. It's freedom. And then they get to be honest too. Where are you at right now, baby? How big is your battery right now? What can I do to charge you up? How can we support you to rest? And we can just normalize in the whole family that we're not a robot.

We're not a robot that is a hundred percent charged all of the time. Who's able to consistently show up in the ways that we expect and the standards that we hold for ourselves or our children a hundred percent of the time. It's not how being a human works. It's a fun practice. So let's move into the heart of power with parenting, and this is all feelings are valid and welcome. And the irony here is let's check ourselves first, before we go out into our parent-child relationship. So where are you at in this power with invitation that my feelings, all of them are real. They're valid. They're welcomed. And do I trust them? Are there any feelings that I'd rather not thank you. Are there any feelings that are really scary? Are there any feelings that you dismiss, like, come on, just get over it. Everybody else can do it. Nobody else feels this way. Everybody else is da, da, da, da.

Where do you find yourself dismissing a feeling, shutting it down, trying to get away from it, making it wrong? And how does that translate to the ways that you're really able to show up in this pillar with your kids? Oftentimes clients and students can, you know, oh I love pillar four, all feelings are valid and welcome. I tell my child that all the time, all your feelings are valid and safe and you get to feel whatever you feel. But for me, yeah, no, not so much. So it's really interesting to notice the incongruence here and not make that bad or wrong either, just find awareness.

Pillar five is attuned and empathetic. So attuned is like it sounds, really being able to tune in to yourself and understand what is happening inside. To really be able to see beyond the moment, to see beyond your behaviors in any given time and to root down into how complex you are, everything that's happening inside of yourself. There's an entire ecosystem in there that is informing any given moment, a lifetime of memories, images coming up and through your unconscious, needs, desires, longings feelings, and it's all swirling around at any given moment expressing itself through our behaviors. And are we able to tune in and to empathize with meaning, be able to hold it as valid again, and then to name it and to navigate it in a healthy and constructive, productive way.

Similarly, with our children, are we really able to see into the heart of the moment. Into the heart, beneath the behaviors, into the root system, and to tend to the need beyond the moment. This is a really, really fun practice as parents to be able to see beneath the moment into what is really happening. And your coach will be able to support you to integrate this practice.

Pillar six is loving kindness and forgiveness. I personally have a practice where every night I look in the mirror and I forgive myself for all of my mistakes that day.

I personally have a practice of cuddling up with my children and asking them, was there anything in this day that didn't feel good for you in my parenting? And I received their feedback and I receive it through the lens of forgiveness of self and loving kindness for my humanness. And the more I am in integrity with that process within myself, the easier I'm able to access that for my children and really model it's okay, let's find forgiveness here. This was an accident and we're learning and let's recommit. All we can do right now is recommit and keep trying. We're just gonna keep trying.

I can't tell you how many clients and students I have, live with the voice inside of their head that is constantly criticizing their every move or beating themselves up, which is such a painful phrase that we use to describe our inner experience as children. Guilt, shame, berating ourselves. It's so painful to see the ways that we've internalized, that really hypercritical, shame based voice and way of navigating mistakes. Mistakes are safe. It's okay. It's okay. Repair is possible. It's not all or nothing. Again, it's not, oh, I yelled so I just shouldn't be a parent anymore. See, I told you I can't do it. I must be a failure. That's not, that's not it. We're really practicing creating that inner loving presence, that inner forgiveness, that grace and the loving kindness that is ever present when we can connect with it. And then give that to our children.

Pillar seven is communication to connect and understand. So this is under the hands of empowered parenting, power with parenting, and this is our ability to, with that attunement, that empathy and that self understanding, be able to communicate what it is that's happening for us, what we're longing for, what we're desiring. And it's a huge emphasis on the ability to listen actively and to reflect back to our children, what we hear them say. So it's the embracing that less is so much more when we're discussing and communicating with our children, drop the lectures, keep it as simple as possible. Ideally keep it story oriented or symbolic or metaphorical with our young children, instead of what I call "parentsplaining" to our kids, just blah, blah, blah, blah. And they're like, I'm not listening to anything you say. Nonviolent communication is the practice that we'll be learning together.

And I love, love, love this practice for, I began nonviolent communication when my kids are in the womb, babies, toddlers, early childhood and on, and I especially love this for tweens and teens who are moving out of that symbolic communication. And they're wanting some sophisticated, very literal, competent way of navigating difficult conversations, negotiations, collaborations, they're starving for that masterful head work. And it's such an honor to be able to really be in integrity and leadership in this way with our kids.



Otherwise we can get as parents very, very frustrated and upset because we're not able to really be the benevolent leader in that communication dynamic and we can begin to feel "walked on", or back talk is taking over the home because we don't have the skills to competently navigate and facilitate a growing and a hungry mind for some very skilled communication.

Pillar eight is nonviolence and safety. So this is a commitment with our literal hands to do no harm. This is the elimination of spanking, throwing, pinching, slapping, whatever else people do with their hands when they're frustrated and angry and believe that harming a child and using fear is the way to teach them to stop having a behavior, which hurts my heart. And we are also committed to being the safe space for our children. That's physically, that's emotionally, psychologically, spiritually. We are committed to being the place where they can be their full, authentic selves without fear of punishment, reprimand, shame, judgment, conditional acceptance, conditional love, humiliation, comparison, the list goes on. And this is a practice, so if you find yourself doing any of these things again, loving kindness and forgiveness is a pillar here. We are committed to seeing you beyond your behavior as a parent. And we're here to really, and why do I struggle to show up as that safe place for my child and what do I need as the parent in order to really access being a harm free, or least harm as possible, space in my relationship with them?

We're almost there. Pillar nine is boundaries from family values, and this is where it gets really fun and innovative and creative because every family is going to have vastly different ways of showing up in their boundaries and what could be classified as permissive in one family, isn't what could be classified as power over in one family, may not be. It's really understanding your core values and your willingness to be curious about where those core values came from. How attached you are to the strategies that honor those core values, how willing you are to collaborate and negotiate and get creative with your children in the household rules or agreements. It's the deconditioning away from punishment when our children do not perfectly live up to, consistently live up to our expectations, and our standards, our rules and our agreements, how do we meet our children in their humanness? How do we meet our children in their process? Do we have space and grace for our kids to have an up and down ride in their ability to show up in the standards and the expectations that we hold for them? What does that look like? How are we modeling our core value that we're expecting our kids to be able to achieve and to consistently show up in?



So this one's really fun. Pillar 10 is play. So this probably gets to be pillar 1.5 pillar 2.5 pillar 3.5, because ideally play is interwoven throughout this entire map. Play is the magic of all of this. This is the glue keeping all of this going. And I do not mean being the entertainer of your children, being the monkey that they watch and they clap for. That's not what this is. This is really being connected to your inner sense of joy and playfulness, your lightheartedness, your ability to laugh when stuff is hitting the fan and it is absolutely pure chaos and how is this even real right now? My husband and I, when both of our children are screaming and everything is just melting into a big pile of blah, we'll look at each other and we're like, what the heck? What can we do here but laugh? If you can't, it's like we either laugh or we cry. Let's choose laughter. It's having a sense of humor.

It's just ridiculous being a parent so much of the time. It's absolutely insane. And when we can laugh about it and find the ridiculous humor, then we're gonna have a lot lower blood pressure and we're gonna make it through this parenting path. And then of course, there's the actual literal benefits of playing with our children and weaving in playfulness into our transitions, into our teaching, into our role modeling and having fun.

We wanna have fun with our kids. We don't wanna just be teaching them not to hit and how to say this and not say this. You know, that's not fun all the time. We wanna have fun. So how do we let go and release and just chill and enjoy life instead of focusing on teaching or skill building or finding the perfect way to communicate something and solve problems collaboratively. Let's just let that go. Let's have fun. What do you guys wanna do today? Let's laugh.

And I'm excited for you all to work through these 10 pillars with your coach to really find where you fall on the continuum. Maybe all of these pillars, one you find yourself really rocking, really able to own in here and in your relationship with your kid. Maybe one or four seven of these pillars, you're like, nah, I have a really hard time accessing this, embodying this. It sounds really nice on paper, but how in the world would I even begin? And that's why you have a coach. Yay! So enjoy working through these with your coach and I'm going to be seeing you all next week for attachment science. So until then be, well, good luck. Stay hydrated. Bye for now.